

Shipping & Delivery SLA Policy

Owning area: Deliveries

Last reviewed: August 2026

Policy ID: DEL-SLA-004

Effective date: 1 September 2026

Policy owner: Director of Delivery Operations

1. Purpose and Overview

This policy defines IronStore's delivery service levels, operational requirements, escalation rules, and customer communication standards for orders shipped within the European Economic Area (EEA), the United Kingdom, and Switzerland.

The policy applies from order release to confirmed delivery, including carrier handover, tracking, failed delivery, delays, damage, and loss. It establishes minimum service expectations for fulfilment centres, marketplace sellers, carriers, Customer Care, and Delivery Operations.

Service levels are measured using timestamps from IronStore's Order Management System (OMS), Warehouse Management System (WMS), and carrier tracking feeds. Unless a product page or checkout promise states a stricter commitment, this policy sets the applicable minimum standard.

2. Scope

This policy covers:

- Orders placed through the IronStore website, mobile application, and approved marketplace channels.
- Standard, express, scheduled, click-and-collect, and bulky-item deliveries.
- Shipments dispatched from IronStore fulfilment centres and approved merchant locations.
- Delivery activity in EEA countries, the UK, and Switzerland.
- Carrier performance, customer notifications, exception handling, and delivery claims.

This policy does not cover:

- Digital products, services, subscriptions, or gift-card-only orders.
- Deliveries to restricted territories, military addresses, or unsupported forwarding services.
- Delays caused solely by customer-requested changes after dispatch.
- Product-specific installation or assembly services unless included in the order confirmation.

3. Policy Statement

IronStore must provide a delivery promise that is achievable, location-specific, and based on current inventory, fulfilment capacity, carrier service, and cut-off times. The promise shown at checkout is the customer-facing SLA.

Orders must be delivered within the promised window unless an approved exception applies. When a delivery risk is identified, IronStore must notify the customer promptly and provide a revised date or an available resolution.

The standard delivery target is measured in calendar days from payment approval and order release. Public holidays, carrier non-operating days, and customer-requested delivery holds are excluded where stated at checkout.

4. Delivery Service Levels

4.1 *Standard parcel delivery*

For in-stock products shipped from an IronStore fulfilment centre:

- Domestic delivery: **2–4 working days** after dispatch.
- Cross-border EEA delivery: **3–7 working days** after dispatch.
- UK and Switzerland delivery: **4–8 working days** after dispatch.
- Dispatch target: **within one working day** of payment approval.
- Orders placed after the published daily cut-off are treated as placed on the next working day.

The checkout promise may be longer for remote areas, customs-controlled destinations, or seller-fulfilled products.

4.2 *Express delivery*

Where offered:

- Dispatch target: **same working day** for orders placed before the local cut-off.
- Domestic delivery: **next working day** after dispatch.
- Cross-border delivery: **1–3 working days** after dispatch.
- Express service must not be offered where carrier capacity, product dimensions, or destination restrictions make the promise unreliable.

Express eligibility is determined by the Delivery Promise Engine and may not be manually overridden without approval from the Regional Delivery Manager.

4.3 *Bulky and special-handling orders*

Bulky products, including furniture, large appliances, fitness equipment, and selected outdoor products, use a scheduled delivery service:

- Customer contact within **two working days** of order release.
- Delivery appointment offered within **5–12 working days**, subject to postcode and capacity.
- Two-person delivery, room-of-choice, installation, or disposal services must be confirmed in the order record.
- Failed appointments caused by the customer may incur a rebooking charge where disclosed before purchase.

Split orders may arrive in separate consignments. The customer must receive a clear explanation of the expected sequence and any additional delivery charges before payment.

5. Operational Procedures

5.1 Order release and fulfilment

The OMS releases orders to the WMS or approved merchant channel after payment approval and fraud screening.

Fulfilment teams must:

- Confirm stock allocation within **four hours** during operating hours.
- Pick, pack, and manifest standard orders within the applicable dispatch target.
- Use packaging appropriate to product dimensions, fragility, and regulatory requirements.
- Scan the parcel at pack station and carrier handover.
- Ensure the tracking number is linked to the correct order and customer notification.

If stock becomes unavailable after checkout, the fulfilment centre must place the order in “inventory exception” status within **two hours**. Customer Care must be notified before the promised dispatch date.

5.2 Carrier handover and tracking

Approved carriers must receive parcels against a manifest or electronic handover record. The first carrier scan should occur within **24 hours** of manifest creation.

Delivery Operations monitors:

- No-scan shipments exceeding **36 hours**.
- Shipments with no movement for **48 hours**.
- Repeated failed delivery attempts.
- Carrier status codes indicating damage, address problems, customs holds, or return to sender.

The Carrier Performance Dashboard in Looker is the primary reporting source. Manual spreadsheets may be used only during system outages and must be reconciled within two working days.

5.3 Customer communication

The following messages must be sent through the Notification Service:

- Order confirmation after successful payment.
- Dispatch confirmation with carrier name and tracking link.
- Out-for-delivery notification where supported.
- Delivery confirmation or collection-ready message.

- Delay, failed-delivery, or address-action notification when required.

A delivery delay of more than **one working day** against the checkout promise requires proactive customer contact. The message must include:

- Current shipment status.
- Revised estimated delivery date.
- Available customer options.
- Customer Care contact route.

Customer Care must not promise compensation, replacement, or refund outside the approved matrix without the required approval.

5.4 Address changes and delivery holds

Before dispatch, address corrections may be made by Customer Care after customer verification. After dispatch:

- Address changes must be requested through the carrier where supported.
- Delivery holds require carrier confirmation and must be recorded in the OMS.
- Any additional carrier charge requires customer approval before acceptance.
- Fraud, account takeover, or high-value address changes must be referred to Trust & Safety.

A customer-requested change resets the delivery commitment where the revised date is shown or explicitly accepted by the customer.

5.5 Failed delivery and returns

For a first failed attempt, the carrier should provide a re-delivery, collection-point, or customer-rescheduling option where available.

IronStore must review shipments after:

- Two failed delivery attempts.
- Five calendar days at a collection point.
- A “return to sender” scan.
- An address exception that remains unresolved for 24 hours.

If a parcel is returned because of carrier error, IronStore must offer a replacement or refund without charging the customer. If the customer supplied an incomplete or incorrect address, resolution follows the Returns and Refunds Policy.

6. Exceptions, Claims, and Compensation

6.1 Service exceptions

The following may suspend or extend the SLA:

- Severe weather, flooding, natural disasters, or major transport disruption.
- Customs inspection or missing import information.
- Regulatory restrictions or border closures.
- Carrier network outage or industrial action.
- Customer-requested changes or unavailable delivery access.
- Incorrect, incomplete, or refused delivery address.

Delivery Operations must classify exceptions in the OMS using the approved reason code. General “carrier delay” is not sufficient where a more specific code is available.

6.2 Lost, damaged, or materially delayed parcels

A parcel may be treated as potentially lost when:

- There is no carrier movement for **five calendar days** after the expected delivery date; or
- The carrier confirms loss; or
- The parcel exceeds the carrier’s investigation threshold.

Customer Care opens a claim in the Carrier Claims Portal and records the case number in the CRM. For damaged goods, photographs, packaging evidence, and product value must be requested where appropriate.

Standard resolution targets are:

- Initial customer response: **within one working day**.
- Carrier claim submission: **within two working days** of confirmed exception.
- Replacement or refund decision: **within three working days** after required evidence is received.

Any goodwill credit above **€25** requires Customer Care Team Lead approval. Credits above **€100**, repeated compensation, or claims involving regulated products require approval from the Customer Care Manager.

6.3 Performance targets

Delivery Operations reports the following monthly measures by country, carrier, fulfilment site, and service type:

- On-time delivery rate: **at least 95%**.
- On-time dispatch rate: **at least 97%**.
- First-attempt delivery success: **at least 92%**.
- Parcel loss rate: **below 0.30%**.
- Customer contacts caused by delivery failure: monitored monthly and reviewed for trend.

A carrier below target for two consecutive months requires a corrective action plan. A third consecutive failure triggers a commercial review and may result in volume reduction or temporary suspension.

7. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Director of Delivery Operations:** Owns this policy, approves material changes, and chairs quarterly SLA reviews.
- **Regional Delivery Managers:** Maintain country-level promises, carrier capacity rules, and exception playbooks.
- **Fulfilment Centre Managers:** Meet dispatch targets, maintain scan compliance, and investigate packing failures.
- **Carrier Management:** Owns contracts, scorecards, claims escalation, and corrective action plans.
- **Customer Care:** Communicates delays, resolves customer cases, and applies the compensation matrix.
- **Trust & Safety:** Reviews suspicious address changes, payment risks, and delivery fraud.
- **Product and Engineering:** Maintain the OMS, WMS integrations, Delivery Promise Engine, and Notification Service.
- **Finance:** Validates carrier credits, customer compensation reporting, and claims recovery.

8. Related Documents and References

- **DEL-PROC-002:** Carrier Onboarding and Service Approval Procedure.
- **DEL-PROC-006:** Delivery Exception and Escalation Playbook.
- **FUL-SOP-011:** Pick, Pack, and Handover Standard.
- **CX-POL-003:** Customer Compensation Matrix.
- **RET-POL-001:** Returns, Refunds, and Replacement Policy.
- **TNS-STD-004:** Address Verification and Delivery Fraud Controls.
- **Carrier Performance Dashboard:** Looker, Delivery Operations workspace.
- **Order Management System:** OMS production reporting and event history.

9. Revision History

- **August 2026 — Version 4.0:** Added express delivery controls, revised cross-border targets, and introduced carrier corrective-action thresholds.
- **February 2026 — Version 3.2:** Updated bulky-item appointment windows and customer communication requirements.
- **September 2025 — Version 3.0:** Consolidated regional delivery SLAs and introduced centralised exception coding.